

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

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STEVEN BROWN,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK; DETECTIVE WALIUR
RAHMAN, Shield # 6428; individually and in his/her
official capacities; and NYPD Officers JOHN and JANE
DOE 1 through 10, individually and in their official
capacities (the names John and Jane Doe being fictitious,
as the true names are presently unknown),

Defendants.

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SUMMONS

Jury Trial Demanded

Plaintiff designates Kings
County as the place of trial.

The basis of venue is:
CPLR § 504(3)

To the above named Defendants:

You are hereby summoned to answer the Complaint in this action, and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney within 20 days after the service of this Summons, exclusive of the day of service, where service is made by delivery upon you personally within the state, or, within 30 days after completion of service where service is made in any other manner. In case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the Complaint.

Dated: NEW YORK, NEW YORK
August 30, 2017

Katherine E. Smith, Esq.
LAW OFFICE OF K.E. SMITH
233 Broadway, Ste. 1800
New York, New York 10279
Tel/ Fax: 347-470-3707
ksmith@legalsmithny.com

TO:

ZACHARY W. CARTER

Corporation Counsel of the City of New York

Attorney for Defendant THE CITY OF NEW YORK

100 Church Street

New York, New York 10007

Detective WALIUR RAHMAN SHIELD# 6428

Narcotics Borough Brooklyn North

245 Glenmore Avenue Brooklyn New York 11212

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS-----X
STEVEN BROWN,

Plaintiff,

-against-

VERIFIED COMPLAINT**Jury Trial Demanded****Index No.****BASIS FOR VENUE:****CPLR § 504(3)**CITY OF NEW YORK; DETECTIVE WALIUR
RAHMAN, Shield # 6428; individually and in his/her
official capacities; and NYPD Officers JOHN and
JANE DOE 1 through 10, individually and in their
official capacities (the names John and Jane Doe being
fictitious, as the true names are presently unknown),Defendants.
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Plaintiff STEVEN BROWN, by his attorneys, LAW OFFICE OF KATHERINE E.
SMITH, complaining of the defendants, respectfully alleges as follows:

FACTS

1. Plaintiff STEVEN BROWN, has been at all relevant times a resident of Kings County in the City and State of New York.
2. Defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, was and is a municipal corporation duly organized and existing under and by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. Defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK, maintains the New York City Police Department, duly authorized public authorities and/or police departments, authorized to perform all functions of a police department as per the applicable sections of the New York State Criminal Procedure Law, acting under the direction and supervision of the aforementioned municipal corporation, The City of New York.

4. At all times relevant defendants Police Officer WALIUR RAHMAN, Shield #6428 and NYPD Defendants John & Jane Doe 1 through 10 (“Doe Defendants”) were police officers, detectives or supervisors employed by the NYPD. Plaintiff does not know the real names and shield / tax numbers of defendants John & Jane Doe 1 through 10.

5. That at all times hereinafter mentioned the defendants, either personally or through their employees, were acting under color of state law and/or in compliance with the official rules, regulations, laws, statutes, customs, usages and/or practices of the State or City of New York.

6. Each and all of the acts of the defendants alleged herein were done by said defendants while acting within the scope of their employment by defendant THE CITY OF NEW YORK.

7. Each and all of the acts of the defendants alleged herein were done by said defendants while acting in furtherance of their employment by defendant THE CITY OF NEW YORK.

STATEMENT OF FACTS

8. On or about March 18, 2016 at or around at 6:50 PM, PLAINTIFF was lawfully within the vicinity of 345 Thatford Ave, Brooklyn, New York.

9. Several unidentified New York City Police Officers, including Detective Waliur Rahman Shield # 6428, and the DOE defendants, came to PLAINTIFF’S residence.

10. PLAINTIFF was in his bedroom when he heard a loud noise.

11. PLAINTIFF went out into the front of the house, to inquire about the noise, when Defendant officers ran towards him, shouting at him “Get Down”.

12. One of the Defendant officers, grabbed PLAINTIFF's head, banged it into the wall, and pushed him to the floor.

13. While PLAINTIFF was on the floor, Defendant officer withdrew his service weapon, placed his weapon to PLAINTIFF'S head, put his knees onto PLAINTIFF'S back and ordered him to not move.

14. The officers searched the PLAINTIFF and the other inhabitants of the residence; Defendants recovered no contraband from PLAINTIFF.

15. Notwithstanding the fact that defendants had no probable cause to believe that PLAINTIFF had committed any crimes or offenses, defendants placed PLAINTIFF into handcuffs and under arrest.

16. PLAINTIFF was subsequently transported to the police precinct, where he was subjected to an invasive strip-search; no contraband was recovered.

17. At the precinct the officers, including defendant Rahman, falsely informed employees of the Kings County District Attorney's Office ("DA's Office") that they had observed PLAINTIFF commit various crimes/offenses.

18. Neither Rahman nor the DOE defendants observed PLAINTIFF violate any laws / ordinances.

19. The allegations made by Defendants to the DA's Office were false, and the defendants knew them to be false at the time the defendants made the allegations.

20. The defendants then forwarded these false allegations to the DA's Office in order to justify the unlawful arrest of PLAINTIFF and to persuade the DA's Office to commence and/or continue the criminal prosecution of PLAINTIFF.

21. The defendants knew and understood that the DA's Office was relying on the truthfulness of defendant's claims and statements in order to evaluate whether to commence a criminal prosecution against the PLAINTIFF. Defendants were aware that the DA's Office assumed that all of the factual statements, claims and allegations that defendants relayed to the DA's Office were truthful in all material respects.

22. From the precinct, PLAINTIFF was then transported to Brooklyn Central Booking.

23. PLAINTIFF was released directly from Central Booking after the DA'S office declined to prosecute his case.

24. PLAINTIFF was released after spending approximately twenty four (24) hours in custody.

25. PLAINTIFF suffered damage as a result of defendants' actions. PLAINTIFF was deprived of liberty, suffered emotional distress, mental anguish, fear, pain, bodily injury, anxiety, embarrassment, humiliation, and reputational damage.

26. PLAINTIFF was deprived of liberty, suffered emotional distress, mental anguish, fear, pain, bodily injury, anxiety, embarrassment, humiliation, and reputational damage.

27. As a result of the aforesaid conduct by defendants, PLAINTIFF was subjected to an illegal, improper and false arrest by the defendants and caused to be falsely imprisoned, detained and confined. The aforesaid actions by the defendants constituted a deprivation of the plaintiff's rights.

FIRST CLAIM
UNDER N.Y. STATE and FEDERAL LAW
FALSE ARREST/IMPRISONMENT

28. PLAINTIFF repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the preceding paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

29. Defendant police officers arrested PLAINTIFF in the absence of probable cause and without a valid warrant.

30. As a result of the aforesaid conduct by defendants, PLAINTIFF was subjected to an illegal, improper and false arrest by the defendants and caused to be falsely imprisoned, detained and confined. The aforesaid actions by the defendants constituted a deprivation of the plaintiff's rights.

31. As a result of the foregoing false imprisonment, PLAINTIFF's liberty was restricted for an extended period of time, PLAINTIFF was put in fear for PLAINTIFF's safety, was humiliated and subjected to handcuffing and other physical restraints.

32. PLAINTIFF was conscious of said confinement and did not consent to same.

33. The confinement of PLAINTIFF was without probable cause and was not otherwise privileged.

34. As a result of the aforementioned conduct, PLAINTIFF has suffered physical and mental injury, together with embarrassment, humiliation, shock, fright and loss of freedom.

SECOND CLAIM
UNDER N.Y. STATE LAW AND FEDERAL LAW
MALICIOUS ABUSE OF PROCESS

35. PLAINTIFF repeats and re-alleges each and every allegation as if fully set forth herein.

36. The individual defendants issued legal process to place PLAINTIFF under arrest.

37. The Municipal Defendants arrested PLAINTIFF in order to obtain collateral objectives outside the legitimate ends of the legal process.

38. The Municipal Defendants acted with intent to do harm to PLAINTIFF without excuse or justification.

39. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, PLAINTIFF sustained, *inter alia*, loss of liberty, loss of earnings, emotional distress, mental anguish, shock, fright, apprehension, embarrassment, humiliation, deprivation of constitutional rights, in addition to the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**THIRD CLAIM
UNDER FEDERAL LAW
DEPRIVATION OF FEDERAL RIGHTS**

40. PLAINTIFF repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the preceding paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

41. All of the aforementioned acts of defendants, their agents, servants and employees, were carried out under the color of state law.

42. All of the aforementioned acts deprived plaintiff of the rights, privileges and immunities guarantee to citizens of the United States by the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States of America, and in violation of 42 U.S.C. § 1983.

43. The acts complained of were carried out by the aforementioned individual defendants in their capacities as police officers with all the actual and/or apparent authority attendant thereto.

44. The acts complained of were carried out by the aforementioned individual defendants in their capacities as police officers, pursuant to the customs, usages, practices, procedures, and the rules of the City of New York and the New York City Police Department, all under the supervision of ranking officers of said department.

45. Defendants, collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law, engaged in conduct which constituted a custom, usage, practice, procedure or rule of the respective municipality/authority, which is forbidden by the Constitution of the United States.

**FOURTH CLAIM
UNDER STATE AND FEDERAL LAW
UNLAWFUL SEARCH AND SEIZURE**

46. PLAINTIFF repeats, reiterates, and realleges each and every allegation contained in the preceding paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

47. As a result of the aforesaid conduct by defendants, PLAINTIFF's person and possessions were illegally and improperly seized and searched without consent, a valid warrant, probable cause, privilege or consent, in violation of her constitutional rights as set forth in the Fourth, Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States.

**FIFTH CLAIM
UNDER FEDERAL LAW
MUNICIPAL LIABILITY**

48. PLAINTIFF repeats, reiterates and realleges each and every allegation contained in the preceding paragraphs with the same force and effect as if fully set forth herein.

49. Defendants, collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law, engaged in conduct that constitutes a custom, usage, practice, procedure or rule of the respective municipality/authority, which is forbidden by the Constitution of the United States.

50. The aforementioned customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of the City of New York and the New York City Police Department include, but are not limited to, the following unconstitutional practices:

- i. arresting individuals regardless of probable cause in order to inflate the officer's arrest statistics; and,
- ii. arresting innocent persons notwithstanding the existence of credible evidence which exonerates the accused of any criminal wrongdoing; and,
- iii. fabricating evidence in connection with their prosecution in order to cover up police misconduct; and,
- iv. fabricating evidence in connection with search warrants in order to effectuate otherwise illegal searches and seizures, and,
- v. fabricating evidence in connection with search warrants in order to cover up police misconduct.

51. The foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of the City of New York and the New York City Police Department constituted deliberate indifference to the safety, well-being and constitutional rights of the plaintiff.

52. The foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of the City of New York and the New York City Police Department were the direct and proximate cause of the constitutional violations suffered by the plaintiff as alleged herein.

53. The foregoing customs, policies, usages, practices, procedures and rules of the City of New York and the New York City Police Department were the moving force behind the constitutional violations suffered by the plaintiff as alleged herein.

54. Defendants, collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law, were directly and actively involved in violating the PLAINTIFF's constitutional rights.

55. Defendants, collectively and individually, while acting under color of state law, acquiesced in a pattern of unconstitutional conduct by subordinate police officers, and were directly responsible for the violation of the plaintiff's constitutional rights.

56. The acts complained of deprived the plaintiff of her right:

- A. Not to be deprived of liberty without due process of law;
- B. To be free from seizure and arrest not based upon probable cause;
- C. Not to have summary punishment imposed upon him; and
- D. To receive equal protection under the law.

WHEREFORE, PLAINTIFF respectfully requests judgment against defendants as follows:

- i. an order awarding compensatory damages in an amount to be determined at trial;
- ii. an order awarding punitive damages in an amount to be determined at trial;
- iii. reasonable attorneys' fees and costs under 42 U.S.C. § 1988; and
- iv. directing such other and further relief as the Court may deem just and proper, together with attorneys' fees, interest, costs and disbursements of this action.

DATED: New York, New York
August 30, 2017

_____/s/_____
Katherine E. Smith
233 Broadway, Ste. 1800
New York, New York 10279
Tel/Fax: 347-470-3707
ksmith@legalsmithny.com
Attorney for Plaintiff

ATTORNEY'S VERIFICATION

KATHERINE E. SMITH, an attorney duly admitted to practice law in the Courts of the State of New York, shows:

That he is a member of THE LAW OFFICE OF KATHERINE E. SMITH the attorneys for plaintiff STEVEN BROWN in the within entitled action

That your deponent has read the foregoing **VERIFIED COMPLAINT** and knows the contents thereof, and that the same is true to her own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters, she believes it to be true.

That the source of the deponent's information are investigation and records in the file.

That the reason why the verification is made by deponent and not by the plaintiff is that the plaintiff is not within the county wherein deponent maintains her office.

Deponent affirms that the foregoing statements are true under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: New York, New York
August 30, 2017

_____/S/_____
Katherine E. Smith